Ratan, Carolyn says. Her mother, 'thought it was the most wonderful thing that [could happen to Carolyn], she just thought he was wonderful [and] he was so polite', she adds. But their relationship was short-lived.

From 1962 onwards, Lady Tata, who was eighty-five, kept indifferent health. As her health waned, she finally wrote to Ratan, telling him about her deteriorating condition. He realized that it would bring her immense joy if he returned to India though she never demanded that he do so. Finally, by July 1962, overwhelmed by concern for his ailing grandmother, Ratan decided to return to India. Carolyn was expected to follow but on 20 October 1962, war broke out between India and China. Although in just about a month, ceasefire was declared in the subcontinent, to an American, the situation looked too fraught. Soon afterwards, the two drifted apart.

Carolyn still harbours a deep regret of not going to India to work out her relationship with Ratan. 'I never gave it a chance; I never went to see what it was like,' she laments.

She later married Owen Jones, an architect, a pilot and a mechanically inclined man. She clarifies that she had a good marriage and did not regret it. She has two children and grandchildren. But in the same breath, she continues demurely, 'The funny thing [is that] I married a man who was very much like Ratan.'

Four years after he had last seen her, in 1966, Ratan located Carolyn and took her and her husband out for dinner. Carolyn was then pregnant with her second child. She says he told her: 'You seem to be happily married, so I decided then and there never to contact you again.'

He never reached out to Carolyn again on his own. But the passage of time did not dim her memories of Ratan.

In November 2006, Owen passed away. In 2007, Carolyn and her friends were watching the Hollywood dramedy, *The Darjeeling Limited*, whose story revolves around three American brothers travelling in India. One of her friends asked her if she had ever thought of going to India. That was all it took to trigger an avalanche of memories. She told her friend, 'I used to know someone who was there. I think he still lives there. Well, I'm going to go home and google and see what I come up with.' When she did so, what came up was not what she had expected at all. Ratan was now chairman of Tata Sons and Tata Trusts. She got his email address and sent him a mail letting him know that she was planning to visit India. Her trip materialized in 2008 when she spent nearly five weeks in the country. Ratan and Carolyn